CompTIA Network+ (N10-009)

Day-by-Day Study Guide

61 study days (Tue, Jul 28 – Sat, Sep 26, 2026) + Exam Day (Sun, Sep 27)

Organized to follow Professor Messer's free N10-009 video course, section by section (§1.1 → §5.5)

Paced for ~30–45 minutes of study per day

Built for a learner with some existing IT experience

How to Use This Guide

This schedule runs 61 daily sessions of about 30–45 minutes, plus one final exam day. It's organized to follow Professor Messer's free N10-009 video course in his own section order — §1.1 through §5.5 — rather than your uploaded guide's internal ordering. That means a few topics (like DHCP/DNS, or the physical-topology recap) got moved to the day where Messer covers them, so the two resources always line up on the same day. Each day's "Messer §" tag in the schedule tells you exactly which section you're on.

Every day lists three things to use together:

- Guide pages — exact page numbers in your uploaded PDF (reordered to match Messer's sequence, so page numbers sometimes jump around or repeat across two days).
- Professor Messer video(s) — his exact video titles and running times for that section. Find them at professormesser.com or the official YouTube playlist (both linked at the end of this document).
- Today's Assignment — a short hands-on task. These build on each other: starting Day 11 you'll design your own small VLSM/subnetting plan, then reuse and extend that same network design through routing, VLANs, wireless security, monitoring, disaster recovery, hardening, and troubleshooting all the way to Week 8. Treat it like one running project, not isolated daily exercises.

A few days are marked "Not in your uploaded guide" — these cover official N10-009 exam objectives (transmission media/connectors, IPv4 subnetting, physical installations, and regulatory compliance/segmentation) that your PDF guide doesn't include as standalone sections. Don't skip these; subnetting in particular is one of the most heavily tested practical skills on the exam. Key concepts are summarized for you, and Professor Messer's videos cover them fully.

- Dates are suggestions, not requirements — if you miss a day, shift everything forward rather than cramming two days into one.
- Every domain ends with a dedicated review + self-test day, and the final week is entirely practice exams and gap-closing.

Exam Quick Facts

Item	Detail
Number of Questions	Up to 90 (multiple choice + performance-based questions)
Time Limit	90 minutes
Passing Score	720 / 900 (about 80%) — you can miss 15–18 questions and still pass
Test Provider	Pearson VUE (in person or online)

Top Exam-Day Tips

- Review core topics lightly the morning of: ports, protocols, OSI/TCP-IP, VLANs, routing protocols, subnetting.
- Get good sleep the night before — a clear mind is your best tool for scenario questions.
- Arrive early with valid ID; prepare your workspace in advance if testing remotely.
- Stay calm — deep breaths help regulate focus and memory recall.
- Skip PBQs if they're eating time; flag and return after finishing multiple-choice.
- Budget about 1 minute per question; don't burn 5+ minutes on any single item.
- Watch for qualifiers like NOT, BEST, or FIRST — they change the whole question.
- Use elimination to improve your odds when guessing.
- Never leave a question unanswered — there's no penalty for guessing.
- Use extra time to revisit flagged questions, but only change an answer if you're certain.

Domain Weighting

Network Troubleshooting carries the most weight — this schedule leans into it hardest in Weeks 6–7.

Domain	Focus	Weight
Domain 1	Networking Concepts	23%
Domain 2	Network Implementation	20%
Domain 3	Network Operations	19%
Domain 4	Network Security	14%
Domain 5	Network Troubleshooting	24%

9-Week Overview

Week	Dates	Focus
Week 1	Tue, Jul 28 – Mon, Aug 03	Domain 1: Networking Concepts
Week 2	Tue, Aug 04 – Mon, Aug 10	Domain 1: Networking Concepts
Week 3	Tue, Aug 11 – Mon, Aug 17	Domain 2: Network Implementation
Week 4	Tue, Aug 18 – Mon, Aug 24	Domain 2: Network Implementation + Domain 3: Network Operations
Week 5	Tue, Aug 25 – Mon, Aug 31	Domain 3: Network Operations + Domain 4: Network Security
Week 6	Tue, Sep 01 – Mon, Sep 07	Domain 4: Network Security + Domain 5: Network Troubleshooting
Week 7	Tue, Sep 08 – Mon, Sep 14	Domain 5: Network Troubleshooting
Week 8	Tue, Sep 15 – Mon, Sep 21	Domain 5: Network Troubleshooting + Glossary Review + Cumulative Review
Week 9	Tue, Sep 22 – Sat, Sep 26	Practice Exams + Final Review

Week 1 — Domain 1: Networking Concepts

Day / Messer §	Topic & Pages	Key Concepts	Professor Messer Video(s)	Today's Assignment
Day 1 *Tue, Jul 28* *Messer §0.1 + §1.1*	**Exam Overview & OSI Model (Layers 7–4)** *Guide: pp. 1–4*	• Exam format: up to 90 Q, 90 min, pass ≈720/900, Pearson VUE • OSI Layers 7–4: Application, Presentation, Session, Transport	• How to Pass Your N10-009 Network+ Exam (7:30) • Understanding the OSI Model (13:51)	No prior material yet — just write the OSI layer mnemonic from memory before bed tonight.
Day 2 *Wed, Jul 29* *Messer §1.1*	**OSI Model (Layers 3–1) & Encapsulation** *Guide: pp. 4–5*	• Network / Data Link / Physical layers • PDUs per layer (segment, packet, frame, bits) • Encapsulation vs. decapsulation	• Understanding the OSI Model (13:51) — finish/rewatch	Builds on Day 1: combine today's Layers 3–1 with yesterday's Layers 7–4 into one complete 7-layer chart, and label each layer's PDU.
Day 3 *Thu, Jul 30* *Messer §1.2*	**Network Appliances & Applications** *Guide: pp. 5–7*	• Router, switch, firewall, AP, modem, hub, bridge • Load balancer, IDS/IPS, proxy, VPN concentrator • Physical vs. virtual appliances	• Networking Devices (14:31) • Networking Functions (13:25)	Builds on Days 1–2: for each device you learned today, write which OSI layer it primarily operates at using your chart.
Day 4 *Fri, Jul 31* *Messer §1.3*	**The Cloud** *Guide: pp. 7–8*	• IaaS / PaaS / SaaS • Public / private / hybrid deployment models • VPN, Direct Connect, VPC, NFV	• Designing the Cloud (9:49) • Cloud Models (5:23)	Builds on Day 3: pick one on-prem device from yesterday (e.g., a firewall) and explain how its role shifts or disappears in IaaS vs. SaaS.
Day 5 *Sat, Aug 01* *Messer §1.4*	**Ports & Protocols, Part 1** *Guide: pp. 8–9*	• TCP vs. UDP • Full port table: FTP 20/21, SSH/SFTP 22, Telnet 23, SMTP 25, DNS 53, DHCP 67/68, HTTP 80, POP3 110, IMAP 143, SNMP 161/162, LDAP 389, HTTPS 443, SMB 445, RDP 3389, SIP 5060/5061	• Introduction to IP (14:10) • Common Ports (20:22)	Builds on Days 1–4: for 5 protocols from today's port table, note which OSI layer handles it and which device would inspect or forward it.
Day 6 *Sun, Aug 02* *Messer §1.4*	**Other Protocols & Network Communication (Traffic Types)** *Guide: pp. 9, 10–11*	• Remaining useful protocols • Unicast / broadcast / multicast / anycast • Multicast range 224.0.0.0/4	• Other Useful Protocols (8:26) • Network Communication (3:55)	Builds on Day 5: for 3 more protocols from yesterday's port table, classify their typical traffic pattern as unicast, broadcast, or multicast.
Day 7 *Mon, Aug 03*	**Transmission Media & Connectors** *Guide: Not in your uploaded guide — an*	• Wired: fiber	• Wireless Networking (6:36)	Builds on Days 5–6: for 3 protocols from your port table, decide which cable/connector type would realistically

Day / Messer §	Topic & Pages	Key Concepts	Professor Messer Video(s)	Today's Assignment
Messer §1.5	*official exam objective it doesn't cover; use the notes below + Messer videos*	(single-mode/multi-mode), coaxial, DAC; wireless: 802.11, cellular, satellite • Fiber connectors: SC, LC, ST, MPO • Copper connectors: RJ45 (Ethernet), RJ11 (phone), F-type (coax), BNC (coax)	• Ethernet Standards (4:04) • Optical Fiber (3:55) • Copper Cabling (7:21) • Network Transceivers (4:51) • Fiber Connectors (3:56) • Copper Connectors (3:31)	carry that traffic and why.

Week 2 — Domain 1: Networking Concepts

Day / Messer §	Topic & Pages	Key Concepts	Professor Messer Video(s)	Today's Assignment
Day 8 *Tue, Aug 04* *Messer §1.6*	**Network Topologies & Network Types** *Guide: pp. 11, 24–26*	• Star / mesh / bus / ring / hybrid topologies • LAN / WAN / MAN / CAN / PAN • Point-to-point vs. point-to-multipoint; WAN tech (MPLS, Metro-E, leased line, DSL)	• Network Topologies (4:42) • Network Architectures (4:53)	Builds on Days 3 & 7: redraw your Day 3 device map as a star topology, then mark which links would be fiber vs. copper based on Day 7.
Day 9 *Wed, Aug 05* *Messer §1.7*	**IPv4 Addressing Basics** *Guide: Not in your uploaded guide — supplement with the notes below + Messer videos*	• Address classes A/B/C/D/E • Public vs. private (RFC1918), APIPA (169.254.0.0/16), loopback (127.0.0.1) • Binary math refresher; classful subnetting	• Binary Math (9:15) • IPv4 Addressing (11:06) • Classful Subnetting (10:58)	Builds on Day 6: take 3 IP addresses and classify each as public/private/APIPA/loopback, then say which protocol from Day 5 you'd use to test each one.
Day 10 *Thu, Aug 06* *Messer §1.7*	**Subnet Masks & CIDR** *Guide: Not in your uploaded guide — supplement with the notes below + Messer videos*	• CIDR notation (/8–/30) • Subnet mask ↔ CIDR conversion • Calculating usable hosts per subnet	• IPv4 Subnet Masks (9:00) • Calculating IPv4 Subnets and Hosts (9:46)	Builds on Day 9: for 192.168.10.0, calculate the subnet mask, CIDR notation, and usable hosts needed for 4, 30, and 60 hosts.
Day 11 *Fri, Aug 07* *Messer §1.7*	**VLSM & Subnetting Practice Drills** *Guide: Not in your uploaded guide — supplement with the notes below + Messer videos*	• Variable Length Subnet Masking (VLSM) • Sizing subnets to actual host requirements • Speed techniques: magic number / seven-second subnetting	• Magic Number Subnetting (21:09) • Seven Second Subnetting (17:03)	Builds on Days 9–10: given one /24, design a VLSM plan for 4 departments needing 50, 25, 10, and 5 hosts — show your math. (Keep this plan — you'll reuse it all study long.)
Day 12 *Sat, Aug 08* *Messer §1.8*	**Network Environments (Emerging Tech)** *Guide: pp. 11–12*	• SDN, Zero Trust, Infrastructure as Code • VXLAN • IPv6 transition: dual stack, tunneling, NAT64/DNS64	• Software Defined Networking (6:56) • Virtual Extensible LAN (5:17) • Zero Trust (6:41) • Infrastructure as Code (8:20) • IPv6 Addressing (13:50)	Builds on Day 4 & Day 11: explain how moving one department to a VPC would change your Day 11 VLSM plan.
Day 13 *Sun, Aug 09* *Messer —*	**Network Services Preview (DHCP/DNS/NAT/VPN/NTP/IPAM)** *Guide: pp. 9–10*	• DHCP DORA process • DNS record types: A, AAAA, MX, CNAME, PTR • NAT/PAT, VPN, NTP strata,	• No dedicated video yet — Messer covers DHCP/DNS/NTP in full depth in Domain 3 (Days 29–30); a light read is enough for now	Builds on Days 9–11: explain how DHCP would actually hand out one of the addresses from your VLSM plan to a new device.

Day / Messer §	Topic & Pages	Key Concepts	Professor Messer Video(s)	Today's Assignment
		IPAM		
Day 14 *Mon, Aug 10* *Messer Review*	**Domain 1 Full Review + Self-Test** *Guide: p. 13 (summary)*	• Everything from Domain 1: OSI, hardware, cloud, ports, transmission media, subnetting, services, traffic types, topologies, emerging tech	• No new video — rewatch whichever Days 1–13 video you feel shakiest on	Cumulative: using only your own notes from Days 1–13 (no peeking), write a one-page 'Domain 1 cheat sheet' covering every topic above. Take a 15–20 question self-quiz.

Week 3 — Domain 2: Network Implementation

Day / Messer §	Topic & Pages	Key Concepts	Professor Messer Video(s)	Today's Assignment
Day 15 *Tue, Aug 11* *Messer §2.1*	**Routing Technologies, Part 1** *Guide: pp. 14–16*	• Static vs. dynamic routing • RIP, OSPF, EIGRP, BGP characteristics • Administrative Distance values	• Static Routing (7:21) • Dynamic Routing (9:12)	Builds on Day 14: pick 2 subnets from your VLSM plan and decide whether you'd connect them with a static route or a dynamic protocol, and why.
Day 16 *Wed, Aug 12* *Messer §2.1*	**Routing Technologies, Part 2** *Guide: pp. 16–17*	• Route summarization & longest prefix match • Convergence • FHRP: HSRP, VRRP, GLBP • NAT/PAT, QoS, traffic shaping vs. policing	• Routing Technologies (16:10) • Network Address Translation (7:02)	Builds on Day 15: write the full route entry (network, mask, AD, metric) you'd expect for one static and one OSPF route to your subnets.
Day 17 *Thu, Aug 13* *Messer §2.2*	**Switching Technologies, Part 1** *Guide: pp. 17–19*	• VLANs, access vs. trunk ports, native VLAN • Inter-VLAN routing: router-on-a-stick, SVI • STP roles/versions, PortFast, BPDU Guard	• VLANs and Trunking (12:29) • Spanning Tree Protocol (6:06)	Builds on Days 8 & 11: assign each Day 11 subnet its own VLAN ID and mark which switch ports would be access vs. trunk.
Day 18 *Fri, Aug 14* *Messer §2.2*	**Switching Technologies, Part 2** *Guide: p. 19*	• Link aggregation: LACP vs. PAgP • Port security violation actions • PoE / PoE+ / PoE++ wattages • Switch stacking	• Interface Configurations (6:40)	Builds on Day 17: for your VLAN plan, decide where you'd enable PortFast vs. where STP must actively block a port.
Day 19 *Sat, Aug 15* *Messer §2.3*	**Wireless Devices, Part 1** *Guide: pp. 19–20*	• 802.11 a/b/g/n/ac/ax — band, max speed, notes • 2.4/5/6 GHz channels; non-overlapping channels 1, 6, 11 • Antenna types: omni vs. directional	• Wireless Technologies (8:34) • Wireless Networking (11:54)	Builds on Day 7: compare the range/interference tradeoffs of 2.4 GHz vs. 5 GHz to the copper-vs-fiber tradeoffs from Day 7.
Day 20 *Sun, Aug 16* *Messer §2.3*	**Wireless Devices, Part 2** *Guide: pp. 20–22*	• WEP → WPA → WPA2 → WPA3 • PSK vs. 802.1X • SSID / BSSID / ESSID • Wireless controllers, CAPWAP/LWAPP	• Network Types (4:41) • Wireless Encryption (3:23)	Builds on Days 17 & 19: design the wireless security (WPA2-Enterprise vs. PSK) for two VLANs from Day 17 — one guest, one admin.

Day / Messer §	Topic & Pages	Key Concepts	Professor Messer Video(s)	Today's Assignment
Day 21 *Mon, Aug 17* *Messer §2.4*	**Physical Installations** *Guide: Not in your uploaded guide — supplement with the notes below + Messer videos*	• Installation implications (cable routing, rack placement) • Power: dual PSU, UPS, PDU, redundant circuits • Environmental factors: temperature, humidity, airflow	• Installing Networks (11:40) • Power (7:19) • Environmental Factors (3:29)	Builds on Day 3: for the device rack you're picturing from Day 3, plan power redundancy (dual PSU/UPS) and note 2 environmental factors that would affect it.

Week 4 — Domain 2: Network Implementation + Domain 3: Network Operations

Day / Messer §	Topic & Pages	Key Concepts	Professor Messer Video(s)	Today's Assignment
Day 22 *Tue, Aug 18* *Messer Review*	**Domain 2 Full Review + Self-Test** *Guide: p. 27 (summary)*	• Routing protocol comparison • VLAN/trunk configuration • Wireless security types • Physical installs • Bonus recap: redo your Day 8 topology as a physical-vs-logical diagram pair	• No new video — rewatch whichever Domain 2 video you feel shakiest on	Cumulative: write a one-page 'Domain 2 cheat sheet' from memory. Take a 15–20 question self-quiz.
Day 23 *Wed, Aug 19* *Messer §3.1*	**Processes & Procedures, Part 1 (Documentation)** *Guide: pp. 28–30*	• Physical vs. logical diagrams, rack diagrams, cable maps • Layer-specific diagrams • Asset / license / warranty management	• Network Documentation (10:42)	Builds on Day 22: create a physical diagram, a logical diagram, and a rack diagram for the network you've been designing since Day 11.
Day 24 *Thu, Aug 20* *Messer §3.1*	**Processes & Procedures, Part 2 (Life-Cycle & Config Mgmt)** *Guide: pp. 30–31*	• Change management (6-step process) • Baseline configuration, version control, config backups • Life-cycle stages: procurement → deployment → maintenance → EOL → decommission • SLAs	• Life Cycle Management (8:17) • Configuration Management (5:19)	Builds on Day 23: write a one-paragraph change request to add a new VLAN (from Day 17) to your network, following the 6-step process.
Day 25 *Fri, Aug 21* *Messer §3.2*	**Network Monitoring, Part 1 (SNMP)** *Guide: pp. 31–33*	• SNMP versions, ports 161/162, components (agent, NMS, MIB) • NetFlow / sFlow / IPFIX • Syslog (port 514)	• SNMP (8:58)	Builds on Days 11 & 17: decide which of your subnets/devices you'd monitor via SNMP vs. Syslog, and why.
Day 26 *Sat, Aug 22* *Messer §3.2*	**Network Monitoring, Part 2 (Logs, Metrics, Packet Capture)** *Guide: pp. 33–34*	• Performance metrics: latency, jitter, error rate, throughput, utilization • Baselining; scheduled vs. ad hoc monitoring • Packet capture (Wireshark/tcpdump), port mirroring/SPAN, SIEM	• Logs and Monitoring (13:06) • Network Solutions (6:57)	Builds on Day 25: pick one metric (latency, jitter, error rate) and describe what a 'normal baseline' vs. an 'alert-worthy' reading would look like for your network.

Day / Messer §	Topic & Pages	Key Concepts	Professor Messer Video(s)	Today's Assignment
Day 27 *Sun, Aug 23* *Messer §3.3*	**Disaster Recovery Concepts** *Guide: pp. 34–36*	● RPO, RTO, MTTR, MTBF definitions ● Backup types: full, incremental, differential, offsite ● Backup testing	● Disaster Recovery (12:09)	Builds on Day 23's diagrams: assign an RPO and RTO to your network design and pick a backup type that would meet them.
Day 28 *Mon, Aug 24* *Messer §3.3*	**High Availability & DR Sites** *Guide: pp. 36–37*	● Hardware/link redundancy, server clustering ● Cold / warm / hot sites ● Active-active vs. active-passive	● Network Redundancy (4:06)	Builds on Day 27: decide whether your network needs a cold, warm, or hot DR site, and whether critical services run active-active or active-passive.

Week 5 — Domain 3: Network Operations + Domain 4: Network Security

Day / Messer §	Topic & Pages	Key Concepts	Professor Messer Video(s)	Today's Assignment
Day 29 *Tue, Aug 25* *Messer §3.4*	**IP Services, Part 1 (DHCP)** *Guide: pp. 9–10, 22–24*	• DHCP options: 3=gateway, 6=DNS, 15=domain name • DHCP relay / ip-helper • DHCP scopes	• DHCP (8:51) • Configuring DHCP (10:18)	Builds on Days 11 & 13: configure (on paper) DHCP options 3, 6, and 15 for one of your subnets.
Day 30 *Wed, Aug 26* *Messer §3.4*	**IP Services, Part 2 (DNS, NTP, IPv6/SLAAC)** *Guide: pp. 9–10, 22–24*	• DNS forward vs. reverse lookup; record types • IPAM, NTP strata, APIPA (169.254.0.0/16) • IPv6 address autoconfiguration (SLAAC)	• An Overview of DNS (16:54) • DNS Records (9:04) • Time Protocols (5:02) • IPv6 and SLAAC (4:53)	Builds on Day 29: create the DNS record type you'd need for a new server on that same subnet.
Day 31 *Thu, Aug 27* *Messer §3.5*	**Network Access (VPN & Remote Access)** *Guide: pp. 37–39*	• VPN types: site-to-site vs. remote access • IPsec, SSL/TLS, L2TP, GRE; split tunneling • RADIUS vs. TACACS+; SSH/Telnet/RDP/VNC; out-of-band management	• VPNs (6:54) • Remote Access (7:52)	Builds on Days 20 & 24: decide whether remote admins connect via site-to-site VPN, remote-access VPN, or SSH, and whether you'd authenticate via RADIUS or TACACS+.
Day 32 *Fri, Aug 28* *Messer Review*	**Domain 3 Full Review + Self-Test** *Guide: p. 39 (summary)*	• SNMP vs. Syslog vs. NetFlow vs. SIEM • RPO vs. RTO vs. MTTR • VPN protocols, change/config management, DR sites	• No new video — rewatch whichever Domain 3 video you feel shakiest on	Cumulative: write a one-page 'Domain 3 cheat sheet' from memory. Take a 15–20 question self-quiz.
Day 33 *Sat, Aug 29* *Messer §4.1*	**Network Security Concepts, Part 1 (CIA / AAA / Zero Trust)** *Guide: pp. 40–42*	• CIA triad; AAA (authN/authZ/accounting) • Defense in depth; Zero Trust • Risk / threat / vulnerability / exploit / mitigation terminology	• Security Concepts (13:06)	Builds on Day 17's VLAN plan: apply the CIA triad to your guest VLAN specifically — one control each for confidentiality, integrity, and availability.
Day 34 *Sun, Aug 30* *Messer §4.1*	**Network Security Concepts, Part 2 (Authentication & Access Control)** *Guide: pp. 47–49*	• Auth methods: password, PIN, biometric, certificate, token, smartcard, SSO • RBAC / ABAC / least privilege • LDAP/LDAPS, Active Directory, RADIUS vs. TACACS+ • MFA factor categories;	• Authentication (12:46) • Security Technologies (7:15)	Builds on Day 31: redesign your remote-access authentication using MFA and least privilege / RBAC.

Day / Messer §	Topic & Pages	Key Concepts	Professor Messer Video(s)	Today's Assignment
		certificate-based auth (PKI)		
Day 35 *Mon, Aug 31* *Messer §4.1*	**Network Security Concepts, Part 3 (Compliance & Segmentation)** *Guide: Not in your uploaded guide — an official exam objective it doesn't cover; supplement with the notes below + Messer videos*	• Regulatory compliance: PCI DSS, GDPR, data locality • Network segmentation: IoT, IIoT, SCADA, ICS, OT, guest, BYOD	• Regulatory Compliance (4:00) • Segmentation Enforcement (6:09)	Builds on Days 17 & 20: decide which VLAN in your plan would need the strictest compliance controls, and why.

Week 6 — Domain 4: Network Security + Domain 5: Network Troubleshooting

Day / Messer §	Topic & Pages	Key Concepts	Professor Messer Video(s)	Today's Assignment
Day 36 *Tue, Sep 01* *Messer §4.2*	**Attack Types, Part 1 (Social Engineering & Malware)** *Guide: pp. 42–43*	• Phishing, spear phishing, whaling, vishing, smishing, pretexting, tailgating, dumpster diving • Virus, worm, trojan, ransomware, spyware, adware, keylogger, rootkit	• Social Engineering (10:56) • Malware (6:41)	Builds on Day 20's wireless security: explain how an evil-twin attack could specifically target the guest Wi-Fi you designed.
Day 37 *Wed, Sep 02* *Messer §4.2*	**Attack Types, Part 2 (Network-Layer Attacks)** *Guide: pp. 43–45*	• DoS/DDoS, MITM • ARP spoofing/poisoning, MAC flooding, VLAN hopping • DNS poisoning, rogue AP / evil twin	• Denial of Service (6:58) • VLAN Hopping (6:35) • MAC Flooding (8:10) • ARP and DNS Poisoning (7:28) • Rogue Services (6:08)	Builds on Day 17 & yesterday: identify which VLAN in your plan is most at risk of VLAN hopping or ARP poisoning, and why.
Day 38 *Thu, Sep 03* *Messer §4.3*	**Network Security Features, Part 1 (Device Hardening)** *Guide: pp. 45–47*	• Device hardening steps • Secure protocols: SSH>Telnet, HTTPS>HTTP, SFTP>FTP, SNMPv3, TLS • Physical security	• Device Security (9:03)	Builds on Day 24 & Day 31: list which of your remote-access protocols are already 'secure by default' (SSH, HTTPS, SFTP) vs. which you'd need to replace.
Day 39 *Fri, Sep 04* *Messer §4.3*	**Network Security Features, Part 2 (ACLs, NAC, Firewalls)** *Guide: p. 47*	• ACLs & implicit deny; VLAN segmentation • Port security actions: shutdown / restrict / protect • NAC (802.1X + RADIUS); honeypot / honeynet • Firewall types: packet filter, stateful, NGFW, host-based, cloud	• Security Rules (10:23)	Builds on Day 33's CIA plan: add port security and NAC rules to the access-layer switches from Day 17.
Day 40 *Sat, Sep 05* *Messer Review*	**Domain 4 Full Review + Self-Test** *Guide: p. 50 (summary)*	• CIA / AAA / Zero Trust • Malware & attack types • NAC, secure protocols, RADIUS vs. TACACS+	• No new video — rewatch whichever Domain 4 video you feel shakiest on	Cumulative: write a one-page 'Domain 4 cheat sheet' from memory. Take a 15–20 question self-quiz.
Day 41 *Sun, Sep 06* *Messer §5.1*	**Troubleshooting Methodology** *Guide: pp. 51–52*	• The 6-step CompTIA process: identify → theory → test → plan → verify → document	• Network Troubleshooting Methodology (8:04)	Builds on Day 23's diagrams: pick any one link in your design and walk it through all 6 troubleshooting steps for a hypothetical 'no connectivity' report.
Day 42	**Physical Issues, Part 1 (Cable**	• Open/short circuits, incorrect	• Cable Issues (14:40)	Builds on Day 7 & yesterday: decide which cable type in your design is most likely to suffer EMI or exceed max

Day / Messer §	Topic & Pages	Key Concepts	Professor Messer Video(s)	Today's Assignment
Mon, Sep 07 *Messer §5.2*	**Issues)** *Guide: pp. 52–53*	pinout (T568A/B), bad crimp • Max cable distance (100 m for Cat5e/6); wrong cable type; EMI • Tools: cable tester, TDR, OTDR, tone generator/probe		distance, and how you'd test it.

Week 7 — Domain 5: Network Troubleshooting

Day / Messer §	Topic & Pages	Key Concepts	Professor Messer Video(s)	Today's Assignment
Day 43 *Tue, Sep 08* *Messer §5.2*	**Physical Issues, Part 2 (Interface & Hardware Issues)** *Guide: pp. 53–54*	• CRC errors, late collisions, runts/giants, interface flapping • Speed/duplex mismatch fixes • PoE and transceiver-mismatch symptoms; fiber issues (dirty connectors, wrong mode, bend radius)	• Interface Issues (9:29) • Hardware Issues (7:34)	Builds on Day 18: explain how a duplex mismatch on one of your access ports would present in interface counters.
Day 44 *Wed, Sep 09* *Messer §5.3*	**Troubleshooting Network Services, Part 1 (Switching Issues)** *Guide: pp. 55–56*	• Wrong port VLAN assignment; trunk misconfiguration; native VLAN mismatch • show vlan brief / show interface trunk • MTU symptoms and fixes	• Switching Issues (9:58)	Builds on Day 17: diagnose 'two hosts on the same VLAN can't talk' using the trunk/native-VLAN concepts from Day 17–18.
Day 45 *Thu, Sep 10* *Messer §5.3*	**Troubleshooting Network Services, Part 2 (Routing & IP Issues)** *Guide: pp. 54–55*	• APIPA as a symptom; DHCP scope exhaustion/relay issues • DNS symptoms: ping-by-IP works but hostname fails • Wrong default gateway, missing static route, NAT/ACL misconfiguration	• Routing and IP Issues (9:37)	Builds on Day 16 & Day 29: diagnose a 'local access works, no internet' complaint and a DHCP-scope-exhaustion complaint on your network.
Day 46 *Fri, Sep 11* *Messer §5.4*	**Performance Issues, Part 1** *Guide: pp. 56–58*	• High latency: causes & fixes • Packet loss: causes & fixes • Bandwidth saturation: causes & fixes (QoS, identify top talkers)	• Performance Issues (7:18)	Builds on Day 26's baseline: use that baseline metric to decide whether a new slowness report is 'normal variation' or 'investigate now'.
Day 47 *Sat, Sep 12* *Messer §5.4*	**Performance Issues, Part 2 (Wireless)** *Guide: p. 58*	• Poor signal, co-channel interference, AP overload • Roaming issues (802.11k/r/v)	• Wireless Issues (9:21)	Builds on Day 20: diagnose a roaming/dead-zone complaint on the wireless network you secured on Day 20.
Day 48 *Sun, Sep 13* *Messer §5.5*	**Tools & Protocols, Part 1 (Command-Line Tools)** *Guide: pp. 58–59*	• ping, tracert/traceroute, ipconfig/ifconfig/ip • nslookup/dig, netstat, arp — what each one is for	• Software Tools (7:29) • Command Line Tools (17:59) • Basic Network Device Commands (8:56)	Builds on Day 45: rewrite yesterday's routing/DHCP diagnosis as the exact ping/tracert/ipconfig commands you'd type, in order.
Day 49 *Mon, Sep 14*	**Tools & Protocols, Part 2 (Monitoring & Hardware Tools)**	• Wireshark/tcpdump, SNMP tools, syslog collectors, SIEM	• Hardware Tools (8:40)	Builds on Day 25: pick one CLI tool from today and one monitoring tool from Day 25, and explain when you'd

Day / Messer §	Topic & Pages	Key Concepts	Professor Messer Video(s)	Today's Assignment
Messer §5.5	*Guide: pp. 59–60*	• Cable tester, TDR/OTDR, tone generator, multimeter, loopback plug		reach for each first.

Week 8 — Domain 5: Network Troubleshooting + Glossary Review + Cumulative Review

Day / Messer §	Topic & Pages	Key Concepts	Professor Messer Video(s)	Today's Assignment
Day 50 *Tue, Sep 15* *Messer Review*	**Domain 5 Full Review + Self-Test** *Guide: p. 61 (summary)*	• 6-step process; CRC/collisions/flapping • DHCP/DNS/NAT fixes; wireless performance • CLI, monitoring, and hardware tools	• No new video — rewatch whichever Domain 5 video you feel shakiest on	Cumulative: write a one-page 'Domain 5 cheat sheet' from memory. Take a 20–25 question self-quiz — this domain is 24% of the exam, don't skip it.
Day 51 *Wed, Sep 16* *Messer —*	**Glossary Sprint A–G** *Guide: pp. 62–65*	• Rapid-fire term review: ACL, APIPA, ARP, BGP, CIDR, CRC, DHCP, DNS, DoS/DDoS, EIGRP, FHRP...	—	Builds on Days 1–14: skim A–G and flag any term that would change how you'd answer a Domain 1 assignment above.
Day 52 *Thu, Sep 17* *Messer —*	**Glossary Sprint H–P** *Guide: pp. 65–68*	• HSRP, ICMP, IDS/IPS, LACP, MAC, NAT, OSPF, PAT, phishing, PoE, port, protocol...	—	Builds on Days 15–32: skim H–P and flag any term that would change how you'd answer a Domain 2 or 3 assignment above.
Day 53 *Fri, Sep 18* *Messer —*	**Glossary Sprint Q–Z** *Guide: pp. 68–71*	• QoS, RADIUS, RIP, SaaS, SLA, SNMP, SSH, SSID, STP, TCP, UDP, VLAN, VPN, VLSM, and remaining terms	—	Builds on Days 33–50: skim Q–Z, then review every term you circled across all three glossary sprints one more time.
Day 54 *Sat, Sep 19* *Messer —*	**Cumulative Review — Domains 1 & 2** *Guide: Revisit summaries pp. 13 & 27*	• Full recap: Networking Concepts + Network Implementation	—	Cumulative capstone: add one Domain-1 and one Domain-2 detail to the network design you've been building since Day 11 that you hadn't considered before.
Day 55 *Sun, Sep 20* *Messer —*	**Cumulative Review — Domains 3 & 4** *Guide: Revisit summaries pp. 39 & 50*	• Full recap: Network Operations + Network Security	—	Cumulative capstone: add one Domain-3 and one Domain-4 detail to the same network design.
Day 56 *Mon, Sep 21* *Messer —*	**Cumulative Review — Domain 5 + Scenarios** *Guide: Revisit summary p. 61*	• Full recap of Troubleshooting (the largest domain at 24%)	—	Cumulative capstone: walk your finished network design through a full Domain-5 troubleshooting scenario, start to finish.

Week 9 — Practice Exams + Final Review

Day / Messer §	Topic & Pages	Key Concepts	Professor Messer Video(s)	Today's Assignment
Day 57 *Tue, Sep 22* *Messer —*	**Full-Length Practice Exam #1 (untimed)** *Guide: —*	• Apply everything across all 5 domains	—	Take a full 90-question practice exam, untimed is fine. Log every missed question by domain.
Day 58 *Wed, Sep 23* *Messer —*	**Targeted Review — Weak Areas from Exam #1** *Guide: Guide pages matching your misses*	• Whatever domains/topics you missed most on Exam #1	—	Re-read the matching pages for each missed question and redo the matching daily assignment above for that topic.
Day 59 *Thu, Sep 24* *Messer —*	**Full-Length Practice Exam #2 (timed, 90 min)** *Guide: —*	• Simulate real exam conditions	—	Take a second full practice exam under the real 90-minute limit. Log every miss by domain.
Day 60 *Fri, Sep 25* *Messer —*	**Targeted Review — Weak Areas + Subnetting Drill** *Guide: Guide pages matching your misses*	• Remaining weak spots; subnetting/VLSM/CIDR practice; port-number recall	—	Rebuild flashcards for remaining misses, then redo Days 9–11's subnetting problems completely from scratch, no notes.
Day 61 *Sat, Sep 26* *Messer —*	**Final Light Review — Memory Aids & Confidence Day** *Guide: Summaries pp. 13, 27, 39, 50, 61*	• OSI mnemonics, port table, AD values, PoE wattages • 6-step troubleshooting process, secure-protocol swaps	—	Skim every 'cheat sheet' you wrote on Days 14, 22, 32, 40, and 50 one final time. Get a good night's sleep — don't cram.

Day 62 — Exam Day (Sun, Sep 27)

No new material today.

- Do a 15–20 minute skim of your key mnemonics and tables only: OSI layers, the port table, AD values, PoE wattages, the 6-step troubleshooting process, and secure-protocol swaps.
- Bring two forms of valid, unexpired ID (check Pearson VUE's current requirements ahead of time).
- Arrive early or log in early for online testing; make sure your workspace is prepared if testing remotely.
- Trust your preparation — you don't need to be perfect. Missing 15–18 questions still passes.

Where to Find Professor Messer's Videos

- Course page (organized by objective, same order as this guide): professormesser.com/network-plus/n10-009/n10-009-video/n10-009-training-course/
- Full YouTube playlist: youtube.com/playlist?list=PLG49S3nxzAnl_tQe3kvnmeMid0mjF8Le8
- Professor Messer also runs free monthly live study groups on YouTube — search "Professor Messer Network+ N10-009 Study Group" for the most recent one.

Rules of Thumb for Gauging Readiness

- Scoring consistently above 80% on domain self-quizzes → you're on track.
- Missing the same topic 2+ times across quizzes → make it a dedicated flashcard deck, not just a re-read.
- Struggling with the running network-design assignment by Week 6 → go back and rebuild it from Day 11 forward; the difficulty is almost always a gap earlier in the chain.